Board 1
North Deals
None Vul

♠ A K 9 8 7 3
♥ 8 2
♦ 9 8 6
♣ J 4

♠ 6 5
♥ 10 6 4
♦ A 7 3
♣ A 10 9 8 2

♠ 10 4
♥ A Q J 3
♦ J 10 5 4
♣ K 7 6

♠ Q J 2
♥ K 9 7 5
♦ K Q 2
♣ Q 5 3

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
	2♠		
All Pass			

2♠ by North
Lead: ♦J

NORTH has a perfect hand for an opening bid of 2♠.

SOUTH will be tempted to respond with his opening hand and good trump support, but he should resist the temptation. To raise a Weak Two-bid to game you should have quick winners, not just points.

Board 2
East Deals
N-S Vul

♠ 6 5
♥ Q 9 4
♦ K 5 4
♣ K 10 9 8 6

♠ Q J 2
♥ A K 7 5
♦ A 7 2
♣ A 5 3

♠ A K 9 8 7 3
♥ 8 2
♦ 9 8 6
♣ J 4

♠ 10 4
♥ J 10 6 3
♦ Q J 10 3
♣ Q 7 2

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
		2♠	Pass
4♠			
All Pass			

4♠ by East
Lead: ♦Q

EAST has the same hand as in Deal 1 and again opens 2♠.

This is the type of hand WEST needs to bid game. Notice that even with all those winners the pair is nowhere close to having a slam. The will probably make just ten tricks.

Board 3
South Deals
E-W Vul

	♠ Q J 6 2 ♥ 7 5 ♦ A 7 2 ♣ Q 7 5 3	
♠ 10 4 ♥ A 10 9 4 ♦ Q J 4 3 ♣ K 10 8		♠ 5 ♥ K Q J 6 3 ♦ K 10 5 ♣ A 9 6 2
	♠ A K 9 8 7 3 ♥ 8 2 ♦ 9 8 6 ♣ J 4	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
			2♠
Pass	4♠		
All Pass			

4♠ by South
Lead: ♦Q

Once more, SOUTH has the same hand as Deals 1 and 2.

This time NORTH has a very poor hand without any chance of making game. However, he should bid 4♠ anyway.

It is very likely that the opponents can make 4♥ if East gets the opportunity to get into the bidding. Hopefully the 4♠ bid will shut him out, and 4♠ probably won't go down more than a couple of tricks.

Board 4
West Deals
Both Vul

	♠ 10 9 8 2 ♥ J 10 4 3 ♦ A 10 ♣ K J 2	
♠ 4 3 ♥ 8 5 ♦ K Q J 9 8 6 2 ♣ 9 7		♠ K Q 7 6 ♥ A 6 2 ♦ 5 3 ♣ A Q 8 3
	♠ A J 5 ♥ K Q 9 7 ♦ 7 4 ♣ 10 6 5 4	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
3♦			
All Pass			

3♦ by West
Lead: ♥J

WEST has a pretty normal preemptive 3♦ bid.

EAST has the equivalent of an opening 1NT bid and will be very tempted to bid 3NT.

That might turn out to be a disaster, particularly if EAST is unable to reach the WEST hand.

EAST should assume WEST can win six tricks if ♦s are trumps. Thinking this way points EAST to her best call - PASS.

Board 5
North Deals
None Vul

♠ 8 7
♥ K Q J 9 7 3 2
♦ 5
♣ 8 6 4

♠ Q 9 5
♥ 8 6 5
♦ Q J 9 8 7
♣ K J

♠ K 2
♥ 10 4
♦ 10 3 2
♣ A Q 10 5 3 2

♠ A J 10 6 4 3
♥ A
♦ A K 6 4
♣ 9 7

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
	3♥	Pass	4♥
All Pass			

4♥ by North
Lead: ♠K

Here SOUTH has the kind of hand you need to raise a preempt to game.

SOUTH assumes that NORTH has a hand with six winners in it. He can provide four more, so that is just enough for game. He bids 4♥.

Board 6
East Deals
E-W Vul

♠ 10 3
♥ 8 7 4
♦ Q J 10 8 6
♣ A 10 4

♠ K 4
♥ K J 5
♦ 9 4 2
♣ K Q J 7 2

♠ A Q J 9 7 6 5
♥ Q 10 2
♦ 7
♣ 6 3

♠ 8 2
♥ A 9 6 3
♦ A K 5 3
♣ 9 8 5

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
		1♠	Pass
2♣	Pass	2♠	Pass
4♠			
All Pass			

4♠ by East
Lead: ♦K

EAST has a 7-card ♠ suit but he is too strong to open with a preemptive bid. So he opens 1♠ instead.

WEST should respond 2♣, and EAST can do nothing but rebid the ♠ suit.

WEST thinks there should be game and bids 4♠

Board 7
South Deals
Both Vul

♠ K Q
♥ Q J
♦ A K Q 6 5
♣ K J 4 2

♠ J 10 9 5 3 2
♥ 8 2
♦ 9 4 3
♣ A 6

♠ A 8
♥ 10 6 5
♦ J 10 8
♣ 10 9 8 7 3

♠ 7 6 4
♥ A K 9 7 4 3
♦ 7 2
♣ Q 5

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
			2♥
Pass	4♥		
All Pass			

4♥ by South
Lead: ♠J

SOUTH is too weak to open 1♥ but just right for 2♥.

Wow! NORTH has 21 HCP and two good ♥s. Could this be time for a slam try?

Nope, no slam here. Suppose SOUTH has six ♥s headed by the AK. The trump suit would certainly be solid, but then SOUTH couldn't possibly have an outside Ace as well or he would have been too strong for a Weak-two opening. So NORTH just bids 4♥.

Board 8
West Deals
None Vul

♠ 10 9 7
♥ A 10 9 8 3
♦ A 10 3
♣ 10 3

♠ J 8 3
♥ K Q J 7 6 2
♦ 8 5
♣ 8 5

♠ A Q 5
♥ 4
♦ K Q 9 4
♣ K J 7 4 2

♠ K 6 4 2
♥ 5
♦ J 7 6 2
♣ A Q 9 6

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
2♥			
All Pass			

2♥ by West
Lead: ♣10

EAST really hates that 2♥ opening by WEST.

But there's no sense bidding and probably making matters worse, so she grits her teeth and passes.

If you think 3NT has a chance you are delusional.

Board 9
South Deals
E-W Vul

♠ A Q J 10 6 5
♥ 7
♦ A 9 5
♣ K J 3

♠ 7 3 2
♥ K 8 5
♦ K 10 8 6 2
♣ 7 2

♠ 9
♥ J 9 3
♦ Q J 7 3
♣ A Q 10 8 4

♠ K 8 4
♥ A Q 10 6 4 2
♦ 4
♣ 9 6 5

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
			2♥
Pass	2♠	Pass	3♠
Pass	4♠		
All Pass			

4♠ by North
Lead: ♠9

NORTH expects to be better off in ♠s than SOUTH would be in 2♥.

Whether or not you play a new suit as a one round force or not, SOUTH should make the 3♠ bid with a hand this good. NORTH then bids the ♠ game.

Board 10
East Deals
Both Vul

♠ 9 4 2
♥ 2
♦ 10 9 7
♣ Q 9 6 5 3 2

♠ A K 7 5
♥ K 6 3
♦ K Q J 5 4
♣ A

♠ 6
♥ A Q J 8 7 5 4
♦ 6 3 2
♣ 8 4

♠ Q J 10 8 3
♥ 10 9
♦ A 8
♣ K J 10 7

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
		3♥	Pass
4NT[1]	Pass	5♦[2]	Pass
6♥			
All Pass			

1. Blackwood
2. 1 ace

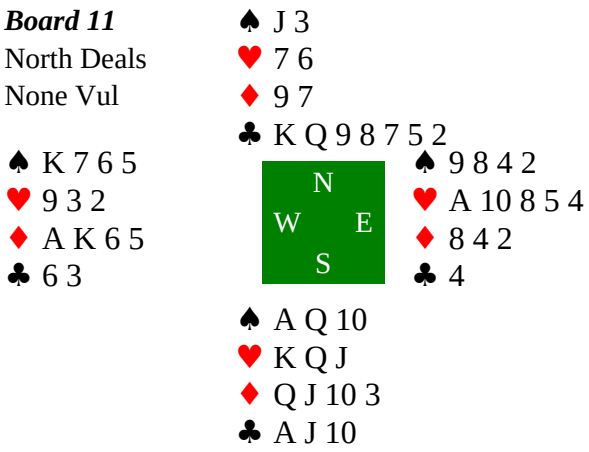
6♥ by East
Lead: ♠Q

EAST has a pretty normal 3♥ opening bid.

WEST, however, has a big hand, and she launches into Blackwood.

When EAST shows one Ace WEST can bid 6♥ with confidence.

Board 11
North Deals
None Vul



West	*North*	*East*	*South*
	3♣	Pass	3NT
All Pass			

3NT by South
Lead: ♦K

NORTH doesn't have much of a 3♣ opening bid.

But SOUTH has just the type of hand you need to bid 3NT after partner's preempt. The other three suits well stopped, and certain entry in Opener's long suit. Notice here that 3NT is a good contract, but 5♣ would go down 1.

Board 12
West Deals
N-S Vul

	♠ 10 7 5 ♥ 7 5 ♦ J 6 4 3 ♣ A 8 6 3	
♠ J 4 ♥ K J 10 9 6 3 ♦ 8 7 5 ♣ 4 2		♠ A Q 6 3 ♥ Q 8 2 ♦ A K Q ♣ K Q J
	♠ K 9 8 2 ♥ A 4 ♦ 10 9 2 ♣ 10 9 7 5	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
2♥	Pass	2NT	Pass
3♥	Pass	4♥	
All Pass			

4♥ by West
Lead: ♦4

When WEST opens with a Weak 2♥ bid, EAST knows she will force to game but is thinking about slam.

But first she needs to know if WEST has anything extra. She bids 2NT to get more information.

WEST returns to ♥s to show bare minimum so EAST settles for game.

Board 13
North Deals
None Vul

♠ K Q 9 8 6 2
♥ 8 6 4
♦ 9 4
♣ K 6

♠ 7 4
♥ Q J 10
♦ K 6 5
♣ A J 10 8 3

♠ A 5
♥ 9 7 2
♦ J 10 8
♣ Q 9 7 5 2

♠ J 10 3
♥ A K 5 3
♦ A Q 7 3 2
♣ 4

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
	2♠	Pass	2NT
Pass	3♣	Pass	3♠
All Pass			

3♠ by North
Lead: ♦J

SOUTH has one of those hands which might or might not be helpful to NORTH. He needs more information about NORTH's hand, so he bids 2NT.

NORTH has a better than average hand, so she bids 3♣ to show a high card in the suit.

SOUTH was hoping for a high card in ♦s rather than ♣s, so he signs off in 3♠

Board 14
West Deals
None Vul

	♠ J 9 8 2 ♥ 10 9 8 7 ♦ 6 5 ♣ Q 10 8	
♠ 7 3 ♥ K 5 3 ♦ K Q 10 8 7 2 ♣ 9 4		♠ A 6 4 ♥ Q 4 2 ♦ A J 4 ♣ A K 6 5
	♠ K Q 10 5 ♥ A J 6 ♦ 9 3 ♣ J 7 3 2	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
2♦	Pass	2NT	Pass
3♥	Pass	3NT	
All Pass			

3NT by East
Lead: ♠K

With four fast winners EAST should think about game. The best approach is usually to use 2NT to find out more about WEST's hand.

EAST found out that WEST has good opening strength, and, most importantly, either the ♥A or ♥K. Now that she doesn't have to worry about the opponents taking the first five ♥ tricks she bids 3NT.

Board 15
North Deals
None Vul

♠ 9 7 5
♥ 7 6
♦ A K Q 9 6 2
♣ 8 3

♠ A 10
♥ J 4 3 2
♦ 10 8 7
♣ K Q J 7

♠ J 6 4 3 2
♥ Q 10 9 5
♦ 5
♣ 9 4 2

♠ K Q 8
♥ A K 8
♦ J 4 3
♣ A 10 6 5

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
	2♦	Pass	2NT
Pass	3NT		
All Pass			

3NT by South
Lead: ♣K

SOUTH is strong enough to be thinking about game, depending on how good NORTH's hand is. So he bids 2NT to get more information.

NORTH has the exact hand to say 3NT - a suit headed by AKQ.

Game (and bidding) doesn't get much easier.

Board 16
West Deals
E-W Vul

	♠ A ♥ K Q 6 ♦ Q 9 6 2 ♣ 10 8 7 4 3	
♠ K Q J 8 7 5 3 ♥ 2 ♦ 7 5 4 ♣ J 5		♠ 10 9 2 ♥ A 8 7 4 3 ♦ 3 ♣ A K 9 2
	♠ 6 4 ♥ J 10 9 5 ♦ A K J 10 8 ♣ Q 6	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
3♠	Pass	4♠	
All Pass			

4♠ by West
Lead: ♥K

EAST assumes her partner can win six tricks. So she will need to contribute four more to make game.

Three of them are obvious, and she expects to get a ♦ ruff also.

Board 17
North Deals
None Vul

♠ A K 8 7 6 2
♥ 8 3
♦ 8 3
♣ K 6 5

♠ 10 3
♥ A Q 10 6
♦ K J 10 7
♣ 10 9 3

♠ J 5 4
♥ K 9 4 2
♦ Q 5 4 2
♣ 8 7

♠ Q 9
♥ J 7 5
♦ A 9 6
♣ A Q J 4 2

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
	1♠	Pass	2♣
Pass	2♠	Pass	4♠
All Pass			

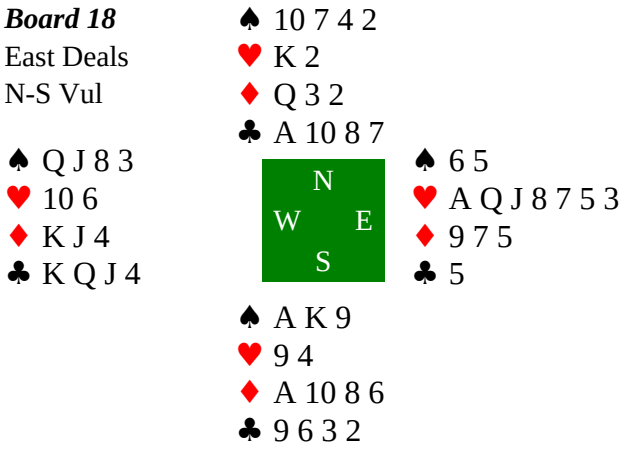
4♠ by North
Lead: ♦4

NORTH's hand has the look of a Weak Two-bid, but it is one point too strong. So she opens 1♠.

SOUTH naturally bids 2♣ and NORTH rebids the ♠ suit.

SOUTH always knew there would be a game bid, so with an 8-card fit he bids 4♠

Board 18
East Deals
N-S Vul



West	*North*	*East*	*South*
		3♥	
All Pass			

3♥ by East
Lead: ♠A

WEST may have an opening hand, but it is just the wrong kind of hand to respond to partner's preemptive bid. She doesn't have the immediate winners that EAST is likely to need, but she is in good shape for defense should the opponents bid.

In other words, WEST has the perfect hand with which to pass.

Board 19
North Deals
None Vul

♠ 5 4
♥ 8 6 3
♦ A K Q 9 7 4
♣ 8 5

♠ A 6
♥ Q 10 9 2
♦ 10 5
♣ Q 10 7 6 3

♠ 10 9 8 7 3 2
♥ J 5 4
♦ 8 2
♣ J 9

♠ K Q J
♥ A K 7
♦ J 6 3
♣ A K 4 2

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
	2♦	Pass	2NT
Pass	3NT	Pass	6NT
All Pass			

6NT by South
Lead: ♣6

The 2NT response to a Weak Two opening is a wonderful tool. You can learn a lot about partner's hand and you are absolutely certain that it will not be passed out.

In this Deal SOUTH has a huge hand and NORTH opens 2♦. There are a lot of approaches SOUTH might try, but the simplest is to start with 2NT.

When NORTH shows ♦ A K Q x x x SOUTH has an easy 6NT bid.

Board 20
West Deals
Both Vul

	♠ 10 4 ♥ 10 8 5 ♦ Q J 3 ♣ J 9 8 6 4	
♠ A Q 9 7 5 2 ♥ K 3 ♦ 8 5 2 ♣ 7 3		♠ K J 6 ♥ A Q J 4 2 ♦ 9 6 4 ♣ A 5
	♠ 8 3 ♥ 9 7 6 ♦ A K 10 7 ♣ K Q 10 2	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
2♠	Pass	2NT	Pass
3♥	Pass	4♠	
All Pass			

4♠ by West
Lead: ♦Q

EAST is unsure whether to bid game or not. So she temporizes with 2NT.

WEST shows an above average hand plus a high card in ♥s.

EAST is no longer unsure, so she bids 4♠.

Board 21
North Deals
None Vul

♠ A Q 9 8 6 4
♥ 5 3
♦ 8 7 3
♣ 7 2

♠ 5 2
♥ 8 7 6
♦ Q J 2
♣ K Q 10 9 6

♠ 10 7
♥ K 10 9
♦ A K 10 5
♣ J 8 4 3

♠ K J 3
♥ A Q J 4 2
♦ 9 6 4
♣ A 5

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
	2♠	Pass	2NT
Pass	3♠		
All Pass			

3♠ by North
Lead: ♦K

SOUTH is unsure whether to bid game or not, so he bids 2NT to get more information about NORTH's hand.

NORTH's 3♠ is discouraging, a hand below average in strength and no outside high card.

SOUTH passes and hopes for the best.

Board 22
West Deals
E-W Vul

	♠ Q 9 4 ♥ 6 5 3 ♦ Q J 6 2 ♣ 10 5 2	
♠ 5 ♥ 8 ♦ 9 7 5 3 ♣ K Q J 9 8 6 3	N W E S	♠ A 6 3 ♥ A K Q J 7 4 2 ♦ A 8 ♣ 4
	♠ K J 10 8 7 2 ♥ 10 9 ♦ K 10 4 ♣ A 7	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
3♣	Pass	4♥	
All Pass			

4♥ by East
Lead: ♣A

EAST has no way to tell whether WEST can provide one winner or not.

So she takes the bold approach and bids 4♥.

If the opening lead is a ♠ or a ♦ then EAST will probably make the game. Otherwise she will likely go down one.

Board 23
North Deals
None Vul

♠ Q J 10 7 4 2
♥ K Q 7 2
♦ 5 2
♣ 9

♠ 9 8
♥ 5 4
♦ K 10 6 3
♣ A Q 7 5 2

♠ A 6 5
♥ 10 8
♦ J 9 8 4
♣ K J 10 3

♠ K 3
♥ A J 9 6 3
♦ A Q 7
♣ 8 6 4

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
	Pass	Pass	1♥
Pass	3♥	Pass	4♥
All Pass			

4♥ by South
Lead: ♠9

Most good players have an extra restriction in their Weak Two-bid guidelines - they won't open with a Weak Two-bid when they hold an outside 4-card Major, even if the hand qualifies otherwise. This Deal shows why.

If NORTH opened with 2♠, SOUTH might well pass and a ♥ game would be missed.

Board 24
East Deals
None Vul

♠ K J 9
♥ K Q 6 5
♦ 9 6
♣ A J 6 2

♠ A Q 3
♥ A J 10
♦ K 7 5 4
♣ Q 10 4

♠ 6 2
♥ 7 4 2
♦ A J 10 8 3 2
♣ K 7

♠ 10 8 7 5 4
♥ 9 8 3
♦ Q
♣ 9 8 5 3

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
		2♦	Pass
2NT	Pass	3♣	Pass
3NT			
All Pass			

3NT by West
Lead: ♥K

WEST responds 2NT, asking for more information.

When EAST shows a decent hand with a high ♣ WEST should bid 3NT.